



Very windy 52/36 • Tomorrow: Mostly cloudy 56/40 B6

Democracy Dies in Darkness

THURSDAY, MARCH 6, 2025 • \$4

One-month pause from tariffs for carmakers

Big Three executives sought reprieve during call with White House

BY DAVID J. LYNCH AND AARON GREGG

Less than 48 hours after slapping tariffs on all goods from Canada and Mexico, President Donald Trump agreed to a one-month reprieve for automobile imports that qualify for duty-free treatment under the North American trade agreement negotiated during his first term.

The president's decision followed a phone conversation with executives from the Big Three automakers — General Motors, Ford and Stellantis — who sought relief from the new import taxes. Each of the automakers over the past several decades has developed complex supply chains that cross North American borders multiple times before delivering a finished product.

Along with disrupting those supply lines, Trump's tariffs would have increased the cost of the typical new car by more than \$10,000, industry groups said. Ford CEO Jim Farley warned last month that the tariffs "would blow a hole in the U.S. industry" and give Asian and European producers a distinct competitive advantage.

Trump spared the automakers after claiming in Tuesday night's address to a joint session of Congress that the most aggressive use of tariffs in nearly a century would bring Americans great riches, though he said that it would be only after "a little disturbance" in the economy.

His tariff pause averts the likely closure of auto plants in all three countries, which would have idled "hundreds of thousands of American autoworkers," according to Flavio Volpe, president of the Automotive Parts Manufacturers' Association in Toronto.

"This is not the president acceding to a request from Canada or Mexico for a carve-out. It's the president making a deal with the automakers he put on the edge of crisis to step back from the brink," Volpe said.

SEE TARIFFS ON A17

The Take: After Trump's celebratory speech, the real test remains. **A4**

Wallet pain: Weary consumers face fresh price hikes from tariffs. **A17**

During Israel-Gaza war, an Arab team in the Israeli Premier League has largely stuck together — and been on the verge of falling apart



For Bnei Sakhnin, the goal is unity

BY KEVIN SIEFF WITH PHOTOGRAPHY BY OFIR BERMAN IN JERUSALEM

The Bnei Sakhnin players ducked through the back entrance of Teddy Stadium, flanked by police escorts. They walked slowly toward the field until the opposing fans, necks craned, spotted them from the stands.

"We will burn your village down!" screamed one man.

"Terrorists!" screamed another, his arm wrapped around a tub of popcorn.

Sakhnin was the most famous Arab team in the Israeli Premier League. On this January afternoon they were playing Beitar Jerusalem, a team with vociferous support among the country's far right. It was the biggest rivalry in Israeli soccer, which had become a microcosm of a divided nation.

Bnei Sakhnin players take part in a training session at their home field, Doha Stadium in Sakhnin, Israel, ahead of their match against Beitar Jerusalem on Jan. 25.

The stadium was decorated with banners of fans who were killed in the Hamas attack on Oct. 7, 2023, and soldiers who had died in the subsequent Israeli invasion. Days before the game, a ceasefire deal marked a possible end to the Israel-Gaza war. But the fissures across Israel and its Premier League had only deepened, endangering the team once considered a testament to Arab integration.

For decades, Sakhnin fans had been careful when they commented on Israeli politics, aware of their tenuous place in the league and broader society. They were Israeli citizens, with the ability to move freely and vote, but they also considered them-

SEE SOCCER ON A10

New limits on sharing intelligence add to U.S. pressure on Ukraine

This article is by Warren P. Strobel, Siobhán O'Grady, Ellen Nakashima, Missy Ryan and Kostiantyn Khudov

The United States has paused major portions of its intelligence-sharing with Ukraine, squeezing the flow of vital information that Kyiv has used to repel invading Russian forces and strike back at select targets inside Russia, according to U.S. and Ukrainian

officials.

The rupture in intelligence-sharing includes a halt in targeting data that U.S. spy agencies supply to Kyiv so it can launch American-provided weapons and Ukrainian-made long-range drones at Russian targets, Ukrainian officials said. Some Ukrainian missile operators say they are no longer receiving information needed to hit targets inside Russia.

The pause comes amid a decision early this week by President Donald Trump to freeze future deliveries of weapons to Ukraine, to pressure Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelensky into peace negotiations with Russia.

CIA Director John Ratcliffe confirmed the latest move Wednesday, telling Fox Business that the United States has paused both intelligence-sharing and weapons systems in the after-

math of a contentious Oval Office meeting last week between Trump and Zelensky. Ratcliffe said the pauses would "go away" once it was clear Zelensky was committed to peace.

The move is another major reversal from the approach of the Biden administration, which set up special systems to share copious amounts of intelligence on Russian military forces with

SEE UKRAINE ON A8

Chinese EV sales humming in automaker-less Australia

Manufacturer BYD's rise poses complications for government of U.S. ally

BY MICHAEL E. MILLER

SYDNEY — Shoppers streamed through a Sydney strip mall on a recent morning, past dueling mattress outlets and into the neon glow of a BYD megastore. As a robot brought them BYD-branded water bottles, the potential customers examined rows of gleaming electric vehicles.

Vanessa Farrer had already paid for one of the Chinese vehicles — a Sealion 6 plug-in hybrid SUV that cost about \$31,000 — and was waiting for it to be delivered a week later.

But her husband, Liam Flood,

had been so impressed that he now wanted to take BYD's new plug-in hybrid pickup truck, called a Shark, for a test drive. Flood, who owns a construction firm, immediately dropped \$38,000 on the Shark.

The couple marveled at how inexpensive Chinese electric vehicles are proving popular in Australia yet are unavailable in the United States.

"I don't think that will change with Trump back in office," Flood said.

Indeed, both Donald Trump and his predecessor as president, Joe Biden, have taken a hard line on Chinese EVs, which have made rapid inroads into the international market: BYD built more electric cars than Tesla last year. Biden effectively blocked their import with a 100 percent tariff aimed at protecting U.S. auto-

SEE AUSTRALIA ON A13



ANDREW MEDICINI/AP

Catholic Church opens solemn Lenten season

Cardinals in Rome conclude Mass on Ash Wednesday without Pope Francis, who is in his third week of hospitalization. The pontiff received ashes and Holy Communion in a morning ceremony.

5-4 court halts bid to freeze aid funds

\$2 BILLION OWED FOR COMPLETED WORK

USAID must schedule delayed payments

BY JUSTIN JOUVENAL, ANNIE GOWEN AND ANN E. MARIMOW

A sharply divided Supreme Court on Wednesday denied the Trump administration's request to block a lower court order on foreign aid funding, clearing the way for the State Department and the U.S. Agency for International Development to restart nearly \$2 billion in payments for work already done.

Chief Justice John G. Roberts Jr. and Justice Amy Coney Barrett joined the court's three liberal justices in the 5-4 order, which was the high court's first significant move on lawsuits related to President Donald Trump's initiatives in his second term.

As is customary in emergency orders, the majority did not explain the reasoning for its decision. It directed the lower court to clarify what obligations the government must fulfill to global health groups, with consideration of the "feasibility of any compliance timelines."

Soon after the ruling, U.S. District Judge Amir H. Ali ordered the government to develop a schedule for restarting the payments.

Aid groups had argued that the Trump administration was flouting Ali's order to pay its bills and hailed the high court's decision as a sign that the president cannot ignore the law.

The majority's decision drew a vigorous dissent from four conservative justices who ques-

SEE COURT ON A6

D.C. buildings: Federal properties targeted for sale no longer listed. **A4**

Pivot signaled: White House is backing off D.C. executive order. **B1**

'Peace through strength': GOP aims to retrofit a Reagan credo

BY ABIGAIL HAUSLOHNER

When Sen. Elissa Slotkin (D-Michigan) appeared on Americans' TV screens late Tuesday night to offer a rebuttal on behalf of her party to President Donald Trump's address to Congress, she invoked a leader not often praised by Democrats: the late president and Republican folk hero Ronald Reagan.

"President Trump loves to say 'peace through strength.' That's actually a line he stole from Ronald Reagan," Slotkin said, referring to the signature Cold War-era doctrine that envisions the combined deterrent effect of a powerful U.S. military and strong democratic alliances. "But let me tell you, after the spectacle that just took place in the Oval Office last week, Reagan must be rolling in his grave."

A curious rhetorical and ideological struggle has been playing out on Capitol Hill and in the White House in recent weeks, as the Trump administration has sought to apply Reagan's "peace

SEE REPUBLICANS ON A8

IN THE NEWS

Alleged hackers charged Twelve Chinese citizens are accused of targeting U.S. agencies, contractors, journalists and others as part of a global cyberespionage scheme. **A14**

New leadership in Pr. George's Aisha Braveboy claimed victory in a special primary to be the county executive. **B1**

THE NATION **Four Democratic** mayors defended their "sanctuary city" policies from GOP attacks. **A3** **The nominee** to lead NIH pledged to restore public trust in science and medicine. **A3**

THE WORLD **Amid Trump's threats,** Canada's Liberals have reversed a substantial polling deficit. **A12** **Israel** outlined a plan to control all humanitarian aid entering Gaza as a ceasefire teeters. **A15**

THE ECONOMY **HR experts say** Elon Musk's "5 things" emails for federal employees will create more confusion than efficiency. **A16**

THE CLIMATE **Hurricane-prone** Alabama is inspiring other states with its grants to help homeowners build "fortified roofs." **A18**

THE REGION **A D.C. man** convicted of murder and freed from prison early was found guilty in a second killing. **B1** **D.C.'s mayor** proposed a 2.7 percent increase to the per-pupil funding formula and \$44 million in new "stability funding" for schools. **B1**

STYLE **Actor Hank Azaria,** a master of voices, is taking his turn at Bruce Springsteen's. **C1** **LOCAL LIVING** **Amid a weedy** landscape for apps that help you plan how your garden grows, there are a handful that stand out from the crowd.

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